

**UNIT
7**

**DIRECT AND
INDIRECT SPEECH**

UNIT 7 DIRECT AND INDIRECT SPEECH

1. Direct Speech

Direct Speech is when we repeat someone's exact words. These words are enclosed in **quotation marks** (" ") and are introduced by a **reporting verb** like **said**, **asked**, or **told**.

Examples:

- She said, "I am happy."
- He asked, "Where are you going?"

In Direct Speech, the sentence is divided into two parts:

1. Reporting speech: This includes the reporting verb and identifies who is speaking.

- **Example:** She said,

2. Reported speech: These are the exact words spoken by the person, written inside quotation marks.

- **Example:** "I am happy."

Rules for Writing Direct Speech

1. Use Quotation Marks:

Always enclose the exact words of the speaker in quotation marks.

Example:

- He said, "I like ice cream."

2. Place the Reporting speech Correctly:

The reporting clause can come:

- At the beginning:

Example: She said, "The weather is nice."

- At the end:

Example: "The weather is nice," she said.

- In the middle (if the quote is long):

Example: "The weather," she said, "is nice today."

3. Use a Comma or Colon After the Reporting Verb:

- If the reporting clause comes first, use a comma or colon before the quoted words.

Example: He said, "I will call you later."

- If the reporting clause comes after, place a comma inside the quotation marks.

Example: "I will call you later," he said.

4. Start the Reported Speech with a Capital Letter:

Begin the first word of the reported speech with a capital letter.

Example:

- She said, "Today is my birthday."

5. Punctuation Inside the Quotation Marks:

- If the quote is a statement, the comma goes inside the quotation marks.

Example: "I am tired," she said.

- If the quote is a question, the question mark stays inside the quotation marks.

Example: He asked, "Where are you going?"

- The same applies to exclamation marks.

Example: "What a beautiful day!" she said.

Examples of Direct Speech

Reporting Speech	Reported Speech
She said,	"I love reading books."
He asked,	"What time is it?"
John told me,	"I will meet you at the park at 5 PM."
Reported Speech	Reporting Speech
"Can you help me?"	she asked.
"I am so excited!"	said Maria.

EXERCISES

Exercise: 1

Which of the following is Direct Speech.

1. Sarah said she was feeling tired.

2. He asked, "Are you coming to the party?"

3. They told us to wait outside.

4. She said that it was raining.

5. "Where is the nearest shop?" he asked.

6. She says that she is studying for the exam.

7. He will say, "We enjoy playing football."

8. They will tell us that the show starts at 8 PM.

9. Maria says that she likes ice cream.

10. He says that he is going to the park.

Exercise: 2

Add the quotation marks and comma.

1. Sarah said I like chocolate.

2. Zain asked What time is the movie?

3. She exclaimed What a wonderful surprise!

4. He said Please pass the salt.

5. Sarah told me I will help you with your homework.

6. Zain asked Can you help me with my project?

7. I am going to the mall tomorrow said Sofia.

8. We are happy to be here they said.

9. He asked Will you join us for dinner?

10. She told me I can finish the task later.

2. Indirect Speech

Indirect Speech is when we report what someone said without using their exact words. Instead of quotation marks, we rephrase the original sentence and make adjustments to the pronouns, verbs, and other words to fit the context.

Examples:

- Direct: She said, "I am happy."
- Indirect: She said that she was happy.

In Indirect Speech, we:

1. Remove quotation marks.
2. Adjust pronouns and verbs as needed.
3. Often use the word **that** to connect the reporting clause with the reported speech.

Rules for Changing Direct Speech to Indirect Speech

1. Change in Tense (Backshifting):

If the reporting verb (e.g., **said, told**) is in the **past tense**, the verb in the reported speech changes to a past tense.

Direct Speech	Indirect Speech
"I am happy," she said.	She said that she was happy.
"He likes football," she said.	She said that he liked football.

Note: If the reporting verb is in the **present** or **future tense**, the tense of the verb in the reported speech remains the same. **No** Change in Tense occurs.

Examples:

- **Direct:** She says, "I like chocolate."
Indirect: She says that she likes chocolate.
- **Direct:** He will say, "I am tired."
Indirect: He will say that he is tired.
- **Direct:** She says, "I am going to the park."
Indirect: She says that she is going to the park.

2. Change in Pronouns:

Pronouns in the reported speech must change to match the speaker's perspective.

Examples:

- **Direct:** "I love ice cream," she said.
Indirect: She said that she loved ice cream.
- **Direct:** "We are going to the park," they said.
Indirect: They said that they were going to the park.

3. Change in Time and Place Words:

Words related to time and place often change in Indirect Speech.

Direct Speech	Indirect Speech
This	That
These	Those
Here	There
Now	Then
Today	That day
Tonight	That night
Tomorrow	The next day
Yesterday	The day before/ the previous day
Next week	The following week
Last week	The previous week

Examples:

- **Direct:** "I will meet you here tomorrow," he said.
Indirect: He said that he would meet me there the next day.

4. Reporting Questions:

- For **Yes/No Questions**, use **if**.
Direct: "Are you coming?" he asked.
Indirect: He asked if I was coming.

- For two choices and more clarity, use **whether**.

Direct: She asked me, "Do you want tea or coffee?"

Indirect: She asked whether I wanted tea or coffee.

- For **Wh- Questions**, keep the question word but turn it into a statement.

Direct: "Where are you going?" she asked.

Indirect: She asked where I was going.

5. Reporting Commands and Requests:

- Use told or asked with to + verb for commands and requests.

Direct: "Close the door," he said.

Indirect: He told me to close the door.

Direct: "Please help me," she said.

Indirect: She requested me to help her.

Examples:

Direct Speech	Indirect Speech
"I am studying," she said.	She said that she was studying.
"We will go to the market," he said.	He said that they would go to the market.
"Can you help me?" she asked.	She asked if I could help her.
"Don't talk loudly," the teacher said.	The teacher told us not to talk loudly.
"I always enjoy books," he says.	He says that he always enjoys books.

Steps to Convert Direct Speech to Indirect Speech

1. Remove the quotation marks.
2. Add **that** to connect the reporting speech and the reported speech if needed. (check the type of sentence to place the conjunction correctly)

Placement of "that" depends on the type of sentence being reported:

1. Statements:

- Always place **"that"** after the reporting verb when converting statements to Indirect Speech.

- **Example:**

- **Direct:** She said, "I am happy."
- **Indirect:** She said **that** she was happy.

2. Questions (Yes/No):

- Do not use **"that"** in Yes/No questions. Instead, use **if** or **whether** to connect the clauses.

- **Example:**

- **Direct:** He asked, "Are you coming?"
- **Indirect:** He asked **if** I was coming.

3. Questions (Wh-):

- Do **not** use **"that"** to connect Wh- questions. Use the Wh- word directly.

- **Example:**

- **Direct:** She asked, "Where are you going?"
- **Indirect:** She asked where I was going.

4. Commands and Requests:

- Do **not** use **"that"** in commands or requests. Use **to + verb** instead.

- **Example:**

- **Direct:** He said, "Close the door."
- **Indirect:** He told me **to close** the door.

Examples:

Direct Speech	Indirect Speech
"I am tired," she said.	She said that she was tired.
"Can you help me?" she asked.	She asked if I could help her.
"What time is the meeting?" he asked.	He asked what time the meeting was.

"Please open the window," she said.

She asked me **to open** the window.

3. Adjust pronouns.

Rules for Adjusting Pronouns

1. First Person Pronouns (I, We, Me, Us):

- Change to match the **subject of the reporting speech** (the reporter).

- **Example:**

- **Direct:** She said, "I am happy."
- **Indirect:** She said that **she** was happy.
- **Direct:** Zain said, "We will win the match."
- **Indirect:** Zain said that **they** would win the match.

2. Second Person Pronouns (You, Your):

- Change to match the **listener** or **object of the reporting speech** (the person being addressed).

- **Example:**

- **Direct:** She said, "You are late."
- **Indirect:** She said that I was late. (if "you" refers to the reporter)
- **Indirect:** She said that **he** was late. (if "you" refers to someone else)

3. Third Person Pronouns (He, She, It, They, Them, His, Her):

- Generally, third-person pronouns **do not change** because they already refer to others.

- **Example:**

- **Direct:** She said, "He is my friend."
- **Indirect:** She said that **he** was her friend.
- **Direct:** They said, "She will join us tomorrow."
- **Indirect:** They said that **she** would join them the next day.

4. Change the tense of the verb if the reporting verb is in the past tense. (If the reporting verb is in the present or future tense, no tense change is needed.)

Tense Changes in Indirect Speech

Direct Speech	Indirect Speech	Example
Present Simple	Past Simple	"I love ice cream," she said. → She said that she loved ice cream.
Present Continuous	Past Continuous	"I am reading a book," he said. → He said that he was reading a book.
Present Perfect	Past Perfect	"I have finished my homework," she said. → She said that she had finished her homework.
Present Perfect Continuous	Past Perfect Continuous	"I have been working," he said. → He said that he had been working.
Past Simple	Past Perfect	"I went to the park," she said. → She said that she had gone to the park.
Past Continuous	Past Perfect Continuous	"I was cooking dinner," he said. → He said that he had been cooking dinner.
Past Perfect	No Change	"I had seen the movie," she said. → She said that she had seen the movie.
Past Perfect Continuous	No Change	"I had been studying," he said. → He said that he had been studying.
Future Simple (will)	Would	"I will call you tomorrow," she said. → She said that she would call me the next day.
Future Continuous (will be)	Would be	"I will be working tomorrow," he said. → He said that he would be working the next day.
Future Perfect (will have)	Would have	"I will have finished by noon," she said. → She said that she would have finished by noon.

5. Change time/place words.

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Last week	The previous week

Exercise: 1

Change the following sentences from Direct to Indirect Speech.

1. She said to me, "I am reading a book."

2. He says, "I will call you tomorrow."

3. Sofia will say to Sarah, "I can use your phone."

4. "Where are you going?" she asked me.

5. "Don't be late," he told me.

6. She said, "We went to the park yesterday."

7. He says, "I always work hard."

8. "I will complete the task next week," he said.

Exercise: 2

Identify the errors in these Indirect Speech sentences and correct them.

1. She said that she is happy.

2. He told me to not shout.

3. They asked if they can come to the party.

4. The teacher said the class starts at 9:00.

5. He asked what are you doing.

6. She said that she is ready.

7. They will say that they went there tomorrow.

8. He told me that he is arriving now.

Exercise: 3

Rewrite the sentences in Indirect Speech.

1. She said, "I am tired."

2. He says, "I am coming to the park."

3. They said to us, "Wait outside."

4. She asked, "Where is the nearest shop?"

5. He said, "I love pizza."

6. He will say, "I need more time."

7. She asked me, "Can I borrow your pen?"

8. They said to me, "Close the window."

Practical Activity

Pair Work:

In pairs, write a short dialogue in Direct Speech. Then, convert it into Indirect Speech. Share your work with the class.

Example Dialogue:

- A: "Did you finish your homework?"
- B: "Yes, I finished it yesterday."

Indirect Speech:

A asked if B had finished his homework. B said that he had finished it the day before.

Change the following sentences from Direct to Indirect Speech:

1. She said, "He is reading a book."

2. He says, "We will meet her tomorrow."

3. Sofia will say, "They like my drawings."

4. She asked, "Where is he going?"

5. He told me, "You are late."

6. She said, "We went to their house yesterday."

7. He says, "I play football every day."

8. He said, "She writes letters to her brother."

9. She asked, "Is he visiting us now?"

10. He asked, "What time does the train arrive?"

11. They will say, "You enjoy spending time with her."

12. He asked, "Why is she crying?"

13. She asked, "Will they come to the meeting?"

14. He said, "I have already spoken to her."

15. Sofia told them, "You look happy today."

Rewrite the following sentences in Indirect Speech.

1. She said, "I am reading my favourite book."

2. He told me, "You are late for the class."

3. They said, "We enjoyed playing in the park yesterday."

4. Maria said, "I have already spoken to her teacher."

5. He told us, "You should wait outside the building."

6. She said, "I like their new car."

7. He said to me, "I live near your house."

8. They said, "We are happy to see them."

9. She asked me, "Where have you kept my book?"

10. He asked, "Why are they making so much noise?"

11. Mariam asked me, "Can you help me with my project?"

12. He asked me, "Where did you go after school?"

13. She said, "I wanted to visit my grandparents."

14. They told us, "You are not allowed to enter the hall."

15. He said, "My brother is coming to pick me up."
